All I Really Need to Know I Learned in Kindergarten - Cinderella

Adapted by Ernest Zulia and David Caldwell
Based on books by Robert Fulghum

NARRATOR: **(Pg 5-6)** Share. Play fair. Don't hit people. Don't take things that don't belong to you. If you hurt someone, say you're sorry. Hold hands and stick together when you cross the street. Live a balanced life – learn some, think some, work and play. And sing and dance and draw. Take a nap each day. **(Pg 7)** Everything you need to know is in there somewhere. **(Pg 8)** If we all stopped to take a nap each day, how much better our world would be? And it's still true, when we go out into the world in these uncertain times, it doesn't matter if you're six years old or sixty – we should all hold hands and stick together.

INTRODUCTION

Welcome to Kindergarten! Today is an exciting day – it's a day devoted to Fairy Tales. And there isn't a better fairy tale than Cinderella! (stage whisper) Just remember . . . everything you need to know is in there somewhere.

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NARRATOR: **(Pg 9-15)** Cinderella was the title on the chalkboard marquee. Given the task of dramatizing a fairy tale for a teacher's conference, the kindergarten class decided on the classic old rags-to-riches story, "Cinderella." You know how it goes: "Shy agreeable protagonist, victimized by abusive step-parent, waits for wise matriarchal figure to rescue here, and deliver her transformed from co-dependency to bliss." In other words; if you're good-looking, good at heart and have a fairy godmother . . . you got it made.

It was a good choice from the teacher's point of view, because there were so many characters and every child in the class could be in the play. There was the absolutely ravishing Cinderella. The evil stepmother. The two wicked but stupid stepsisters. The

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beautiful and wise fairy godmother. The pumpkin, mice, coachmen, horses, king. All the people at the King's ball. And of course, *(strikes a cocky pose)* the Prince.

The children were allowed to choose roles for themselves. Finally, every child had a part. Except one. One small boy. Who had remained quiet and disengaged from the selection process. Norman. A kid who was somehow different – not weird, just different – in the way he/she looked at things. Norman was always thinking. And like so many misunderstood, but great thinkers, Norman was teased a lot by his classmates, causing him to live on the fringe of kindergarten society. *(during these lines the actor transforms into Norman a deeply earnest and serious individual)*

TEACHER: Well, Norman what are you going to be?

NORMAN: Well, I am going to be the pig.

TEACHER: Pig? There is no pig in the story of Cinderella.

NORMAN: *(after a long pause, matter-of-factly)* Well . . . There is now.

NARRATOR: Norman did not relate to being a footman or a mouse of a pumpkin. He knew his character. Pig. And he intended to participate wherever pigs fit into the scheme of things. Without giving up dignity or identity. He took it for granted that there was a place for pigs, and that the teacher would know that.

What do you say to a kid who is already thinking up a costume of pink long underwear, pipe-cleaner tail, and a paper cup for a nose? *(knowing this is the real question)* And what do you say to all the pigs? All those who are different and who do not accept the available boxes and pigeonholes? What did the teacher say? Well, sometimes teacher talk more like fairy godmothers!

TEACHER: *(thinking very hard, then waiving her own invisible magic wand)* So be it!

NARRATOR: And since there was nothing in the script explaining what the pig was supposed to do, the action was left up to Norman. Norman gave himself one of the all-time best walk-on parts in the history of children's theatre. He decided he was Cinderella's "personal pig"

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(pause) Where she went . . . he went. He made no sound. He simply sat on his back haunches and observed. The expressions on his face reflected the details of the dramatic action. Worried *(respond with intense facial expressions for each emotion)* Sad . . . Hopeful . . . Puzzled . . . Mad . . . as the moment required.

There was no doubt what was going on, and no doubt that it was important. One look at the pig and you know. The pig was so earnest. So sincere. So very . . . "there." Norman created such dramatic tension that people who knew how this story was supposed to end began to have doubts. When the Prince finally placed the glass slipper on Cinderella's foot and the ecstatic couple rode off to live happily ever after, Norman ***finally*** made his move.

NORMAN: *(Explodes into a spontaneous dance of joy with reckless abandon)*

NARRATOR: He went wild with joy, dancing around the stage on his back feet . . .

NORMAN: *(barks wildly, ending with a long howl) (when he stops, pause, then)*

NARRATOR: . . . and barking like a dog??

TEACHER: *(to Norman)* Even if there was a pig in the Cinderella story, there is no such thing as a dancing, barking pig.

NORMAN: *(matter-of-factly)* Well, there is now. *(He holds his ground as the teacher contemplates this statement)*

TEACHER: *(considers Norman with respect)* It's true, Norman, it's true . . . Knock 'em dead, pig!

NARRATOR: The presentation at the teachers' conference was a smash hit!

NORMAN: *(dances in slow motion)*

NARRATOR: When Norman danced his dance, the crowd of weary teachers laughed . . . and wept . . . and cheered

TEACHERS: *(cheer)*

NARRATOR: And later when the pig stumbled out for his curtain call.

NORMAN: *(crosses for his bow)*

CROWD: *(chanting)* NORMAN . . NORMAN . . . NORMAN!

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NARRATOR: The teachers were able to see that the real Cinderella was not the little girl with the button nose and blonde hair . . . but Norman, the dancing, barking pig. And they knew the real fairy godmother was not the child waiving her fairy wand, but the teacher, standing weeping in the wings. *(beat)* Kindergarten teachers know magic when they see it.

(as an epilogue) Well, the kindergarten class had many invitations to perform their highly acclaimed production of "Cinderella." Sometimes the teacher would have to explain what it was about the performance that was so unique.

TEACHER: It has a pig in it, you see . . . the star of the show is a dancing, barking pig.

AUDIENCE MEMBER: But there is no dancing, barking pig in "Cinderella."

NARRATOR: Well, there is now! *(Break into Norman's unique dance and end with a bark and howl)*

SOURCE INFORMATION

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